

TABLE 7.12 : FERTILITY RATES BY ZONES - 1963 AND 1971

	Crude Birth Rates			General Fertility Rates*			Total Fertility Rates		
	1963	1971	Percent Change	1963	1971	Percent Change	1963	1971	Percent Change
Zone I	31.7	27.9	-11.99	150.4	125.8	-16.35	4.61	3.81	-17.35
Zone II	40.0	33.8	-15.5	218.3	167.4	-23.27	6.24	4.97	-20.35
Zone III	36.9	33.4	-9.49	188.4	164.3	-12.79	5.52	4.95	-10.33
Zone IV	34.7	30.1	-13.26	168.3	135.7	-19.37	4.98	4.07	-18.27
Sri Lanka	34.4	30.2	-12.21	166.8	138.7	-15.91	5.04	4.16	-17.46

* Based on the age group 15 - 44 years.

Regional differentials - Table 7.12 shows crude birth rates, general fertility rates and total fertility rates by Zones. The ranking of the Zones as highlighted by the indices is the same in 1963 and 1971 and is as follows starting from the one with highest fertility.

- (1) ZONE II (3) ZONE IV
(2) ZONE III (4) ZONE I

It is encouraging to note that reductions in fertility have occurred in all Zones with the largest decline taking place in the highest fertility Zone during the intercensal period 1963-71.

Educational differentials - Much interest is at present focussed, especially in developing countries on the potential use of female educational attainments as an effective tool towards fertility reduction. At the 1971 Census ever-married women of the childbearing span were classified according to five levels of educational attainments, namely, No Schooling, Passed Grades 1-4 or 5-9, Passed General Certificate of Education (Ordinary Level), Passed General Certificate of Education (Advanced Level) or higher and number of live births borne. After necessary adjustments for the non-specification of the number of births in respect of certain women Table 7.13 was obtained. In each segment of the reproductive span a gradual reduction in live-births ever born is observed with the attainment of higher levels of educational attainment. This Table throws light on the inverse association of female educational attainment and fertility.

TABLE 7.13 : NUMBER OF LIVE BIRTHS BORNE BY EVER MARRIED WOMEN ACCORDING TO AGE AND EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT AND FERTILITY INDICES CONSIDERING THE LIVE-BIRTHS BORNE BY WOMEN WITH NO SCHOOLING AS EQUIVALENT TO 100.

Age Group	No Schooling	Grade (1-4)	Grade (5-9)	Passed G.C.E. (O.L.)	Passed G.C.E. (A.L.) or higher
Live births per ever married woman.					
15-19	0.633	0.624	0.534	0.380	-
20-24	1.681	1.634	1.365	0.942	0.519
25-29	3.100	3.077	2.480	1.580	0.940
30-34	4.463	4.426	3.665	2.415	1.859
35-39	5.706	5.450	4.593	3.221	2.561
40-44	6.035	5.687	5.080	3.594	3.099
45-49	5.973	5.758	5.084	4.094	3.240

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